

Chapter

Seven Chakras, Seven Worlds — The Competent Guru and the Awakening of Kundalini



Introduction: One Chakra, Many Lifetimes

The yogic tradition sees human consciousness through seven **chakras** — from **Muladhara** at the base of the spine to **Sahasrara** at the crown of the head. The dormant energy that rises through these chakras is called **Kundalini**. In this short discourse, Acharya Upendra Ji states in the very first sentence how long this journey is:

"To rise even one chakra takes many lifetimes."

And then, just as clearly, he says what a competent Guru can do on this journey:

"One who is a Guru can raise three or four chakras at once in a single sadhana. For some, it can go all the way from Muladhara to Sahasrara — from Valya to Valmiki."

Valya was the robber who, by the grace of Narada Muni, became the sage **Valmiki** — the example shows how complete a transformation can be in the hands of the right Guru. In this chapter we will see, in Acharya Ji's words, what a person living at each chakra is like, and how the Guru's sadhana changes this sequence.

1. The Lower Three Chakras: From Self-Interest to Family

The lowest chakra is **Muladhara**. When it is disturbed, a person's life shrinks to themselves alone:

"A man living at the Muladhara chakra may remain in this state — only for selfishness, only for himself, and ready to kill or be killed. If the Muladhara is spoiled."

Above it, at the **Svadhishthana** chakra, the circle widens a little, but only up to the family:

"Svadhishthana chakra — he would live only for 'me and my family.' Have you seen all such people or not? Those who live only that much of a life."

The third chakra is **Manipura**. Here a person does reach out to the world, but with calculation:

"People up to the Manipura chakra perhaps do help the world, but there is benefit to themselves, benefit to their family."

Acharya Ji also lays bare the real nature of service at this level:

"Such people exist for name-fame — in the name of social service, or in the name of some remedy. Only then will they help: 'Show us our own benefit, only then will we do it.'"

2. The Heart Chakra: When Compassion Runs Without Discernment

The fourth chakra is the **heart chakra** (Anahata) — the centre of compassion and love. It is usually considered a very high state, but Acharya Ji gives a warning. When only the heart is awake and discernment is not with it, even compassion can do harm:

"Then the heart chakra people — that is called idiotic compassion. They give their entire month's salary to the temple and leave their home and family on an empty stomach. That is also called idiotic compassion."

For this he gives an episode from the Ramayana — Sita Mata and the **Lakshman Rekha**:

"Or like the Lakshman Rekha that was given to Sita Mata — she had been told, 'Do not give to Ravana' — she could not recognise him, and had to go with him. So this type of giving — the heart chakra is awake, yes."

Such people keep giving even at the cost of their own lives:

"Even if their own life is ruined, that's fine, but keep helping people. They never apply their intellect at all."

And here Acharya Ji names the root cause — not listening to the Guru, and continuing to give even to the **apatra** (one unworthy of receiving charity):

"They don't follow the Guru; by their own will they keep doing seva and charity, keep doing it — they will keep giving even to the unworthy. Then that state comes when only the heart chakra is awake."

The lesson is clear: compassion is essential, but without discernment and without the Guru's guidance it is incomplete.

3. The Upper Three Chakras: Leadership, Surrender and Merging

Above the heart is the **Vishuddhi** chakra — the centre of the throat. Here radiance and leadership come into a person:

"Above that, the Vishuddhi chakra people — people with some radiance, with leadership. They can lead, they can change the world."

But even at this level the "I" is not fully erased:

"Those who live for others, but their own name will also be made — they are of that kind."

The sixth chakra is **Ajna** — the centre between the eyebrows, where the centre of life moves away from oneself to the Guru:

"Those who come up to the Ajna chakra are people who live for the Guru — completely surrendered. Only Guru, Guru, Guru. The aim of their life is the Guru's work, the goal."

And finally **Sahasrara** — where no difference remains between the seeker and the goal:

"And Sahasrara — meaning he himself has already merged into the Guru or the Supreme Lord."

4. Seven Levels, Seven Worlds

This description is not only a matter of scripture; Acharya Ji tells the listeners to see it around them:

"Have you seen such different people or not? The people of seven levels — people of all seven levels — do you see seven worlds outside or not?"

And the most serious point is that most people remain stuck at a single level:

"And don't you see that often their entire life has passed at one level? Whatever I described, the whole life is just like that — many years, many lifetimes."

5. The Guru's Sadhana: A Fast Forward Through Lifetimes

From here one understands the value of a competent Guru's sadhana. The journey that would naturally take many lifetimes, the Guru can bring about in a single sadhana:

"Understand what the Guru sometimes does in a sadhana. In one sadhana your chakra, your Kundalini, is raised — so, breaking your bondage of that many lifetimes, he fast forwards that many lives of yours."

That is why Acharya Ji warns:

"So don't take sadhana to be a game."

After **Shaktipat** — the transmission of spiritual energy from Guru to disciple — when the Kundalini rises, the person's old self is left behind:

"Shaktipat means — when the Kundalini Shakti rises, what happens, did you understand? Then you suddenly forget who I was before and who I am now."

"So often many people have forgotten what their earlier world was, whom I used to live with — that I used to live with the wrong people."

6. Your Company Changes: Acharya Ji's Guarantee

When the level of consciousness changes, the world around you changes too. Acharya Ji describes three forms this takes, and calls it his guarantee:

"You too will experience it after a few days: either bad people will leave you on their own, or you will feel the desire to move away, or they will join you and become good. This is my guarantee."

Summary: Key Teachings

- 1 Rising even one chakra takes many lifetimes; most people spend their whole life — and many lifetimes — at a single level.

- 2 Each chakra is a different world:** self-interest at Muladhara, "me and my family" at Svadhishtana, service for profit at Manipura, compassion without discernment at the heart, leadership along with one's own name at Vishuddhi, complete surrender to the Guru at Ajna, and merging into the Guru or the Supreme Lord at Sahasrara.
- 3 Compassion without discernment is "idiotic compassion"** — giving while leaving one's family hungry, or giving to the unworthy, is an incomplete form of the heart's awakening. The Guru's guidance brings it into balance.
- 4 A competent Guru can raise three or four chakras in a single sadhana** — breaking the bondage of many lifetimes and fast forwarding one's life. So sadhana must not be taken as a game.
- 5 After Shaktipat, the old identity and the old company begin to fall away:** bad people either move away on their own, or you feel the desire to move away from them, or they join you and become good.